

content. For example, suppose a variable is set a value. If someone tries to modify it, it will not replace but will create a new value and set it to another variable. Developers should make use of these variable wisely. String are also immutable in Python like Java.

Best Practices in PHP

PHP is a server side scripting language. PHP code can be embedded into HTML. It generally creates dynamic web page content or dynamic images used on websites. PHP also can be used for command-line scripting and graphical user interface (GUI) applications at client side. PHP is compatible with most of the web servers. Many popular website uses PHP. There are various reasons behind its popularity – it is open source, easy to learn, easy to use. Here are some PHP specific guidelines developers should follow.

Always use `<?php?>`: Many developer uses short tags like “`<?>`” or “`<%>`”. All these tags are either deprecated or not official. It is better to write the proper tag rather than make the code incompatible with future version of PHP. Sometimes due to this, conflicts arise with XML parsers.

Indentation, White Spacing and Line Length: PHP developer should specifically consider these three. Some of the guidelines for these are:

- An indent should be of 4 spaces
- Tab should not be used.
- L line length should be less than 80 characters to make the code easily readable and debuggable.

Single Quoted vs. Doubles Quoted Strings: Developers need to understand the difference between the single quoted strings and the double quoted strings. Single quotes should be used if there is a simple string to display. If there are variables and special characters in the string, then they need to use double quotes. Then only those strings will be parsed by the PHP interpreter. Generally, it takes more execution time than simple strings.

Should not use functions inside loops: People often make the mistake of using functions inside loops. If there is a function inside the loop the function will be executed every time the loop will be executed. It will affect the performance of the program to a great extent. To avoid this, store the value returned by the function in a separate variable before the loop.

Using Single Quotes around Array Indexes: There is a difference between `$array['quotes']` and `$array[quotes]`. PHP has a unique feature, that is it can use unquoted strings as an array. And the constant should be defined beforehand, otherwise a warning will be displaced.